

If you've followed the steps and already have something in the D: drive, you'll find that everything that is available in the D: drive is also available under C:\mountpoint.

Hopefully the small exercise above has helped you understand the concept of 'mounting' and it would've become clear that drive letters are a way to make the partitions appear simple to the user. Linux (or say the UNIX) developers chose to have the way of having one folder and keeping everything under it. They decided to make the contents of different partitions appear as directories or folders within one folder. This is the reason Linux uses a different style for the path of files.

If you remember us talking about partitioning in the installation section, you would recollect that we mentioned something about the root folder. The root folder is the main folder under which everything else is kept. We denote it as '/'. It is this reason that all paths on Linux will start with a '/'.

Before you start hunting down things on your Ubuntu machine, let's familiarize you with the folders (or directories) that essentially exist on all Linux machines and are required for its working.

/bin: This directory contains the commands which should be available to all users. It would normally contain the executable files for commands like ls, cal, grep etc which are used in everyday Linux environment, directly or indirectly.

/boot: This directory would contain the boot files which are used to bring the system up. It includes the kernel (vmlinuz), ramdisk image (initrd.lz) and bootloader configuration files.

/dev: This directory does not consume any space on disk and is used to keep track of devices connected to the computer including the ones which are a part of the CPU such as the disks, modems, display, sound card etc.

/etc: If you were to change some setting and didn't know where to look for it, you'd probably head towards this directory. It contains all the configuration files, ranging from the ones which control the booting of computer to the ones which can change the behaviour of installed software and services.

/home: We've already told you that the 'home' is the user profile folder in Linux. This directory closely resembles the C:\Users folder on Windows. Every user on the system would have a separate directory within this sub-directory.

/lib: Linux keeps its libraries in this folder. If you've never heard the word 'library' in context of computing, we'd define it as a reusable resource that more than a single software can depend on. For example, if more than one